

U.S. History





About the Course

Read United States and world history stories from the current history cycle (1800-1900). View images and reference atlases and maps to set the people and events in their time and place. Update History Charts as appropriate for student level.

This topic is included in the following course(s): History: Grade 4 (U.S.), History: Grades 5-6 (U.S.)



Placement & Combining Tips

This course is the same for 4th-6th graders. In grade 5, students may begin their Book of Centuries.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
4-6	U.S. History: Grades 4-6 1 time/week 25 min	Heart and Soul: The Story of America and African Americans Children of the Wild West Lincoln: A Photobiography SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grade 4 (U.S.)				
	U.S. History: Grades 4-6		World History: Grades 4-6	
History: Grades 5-6 (U.S.)				
	U.S. History: Grades 4-6		World History: Grades 4-6	Ancient History: Grades 5-6



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

☐ Read the document in the Quick Links about History Timelines and Charts.

☐ We encourage you to pick a biography for each term to read in the afternoons. The Bookshelf has many recommendations.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

U.S. History: Grades 4-6



Heart and Soul: The Story of America and African Americans



Children of the Wild West



Lincoln: A Photobiography



SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [U.S. History: Grades 4-6 Student Lessons \(No Answers\)](#)

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.



Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Grade 4 U.S. History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [History Charts & Timeline Scope & Sample](#)
- ∞ [Century Chart](#)
- ∞ [Grade 5 U.S. History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Grade 6 U.S. History Chart Prompta](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 15: History.\)](#)
- ∞ [History: Grade 4 Student Lessons \(No Answers\)](#)
- ∞ [History: Grades 5-6 Student Lessons \(No Answers\)](#)

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the student's pace for the lesson time rather than a particular number of pages. It is vitally important that teachers not try to 'force feed' a student more than they can consume in one sitting.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they

are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.

U.S. History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 1

A Duck, A Dog, and a Deal

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ PREP

1. Please note that a few of the chapters will be skipped for the sake of time. You can encourage your student to read those chapters outside of lesson time.
2. You may want to read the introduction to get some more background knowledge about the book.

→ INTRO

This year, we are studying the history of the United States from 1800-1900. President Thomas Jefferson acquired a large amount of land west of the Mississippi for \$15 million through the Louisiana Purchase from France. He chose Meriwether Lewis to head an expedition to explore this area. Along with William Clark and a select group of men, a dog named Seaman joined the expedition. We learn about this dog in the journals of Lewis and Clark. For a long time, people thought the name of the dog was Scannon because it was hard to read the handwriting. Over the years, more information about Seaman has been found in the journals and other sources. That is what makes the study of history interesting—historians continue to find more evidence that adds to a fuller understanding of the past. The author wrote this story based on Lewis and Clark's journals, which were originally written with a quill pen!

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Map at the back of the book

At the beginning of the book, Lewis is in Pittsburgh and then needs to meet Clark before heading to Fort Wood, where they will spend the winter before they begin their expedition. Trace this route on the map. What rivers will he be traveling along to get to the camp? [A: Ohio and Mississippi]

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-11 "The huge black" - "lift their spirits."

- One of the goals of the expedition was to look for the Northwest Passage. Many thought there would be a direct water route across the continent that led to the Pacific Ocean. It was believed that this waterway could open a direct trade route between North America and Asia. Lewis and Clark were to find out and let President Jefferson know. Do you know if there is a direct water route from the Atlantic to the Pacific? You can look at a map to find out.

→ VIEW

Look at the entry from Lewis's journal on p.9. What do you notice about the spelling? Spelling changes over time. You will notice different spellings in the other entries as well.

• EXTRA HELPING

If you have time, this is an interesting video that talks about the Louisiana Purchase and the reasons for the expedition.

∞ Video Link: Lewis and Clark Expedition Part 1

WEEK 2 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 2

Getting Ready

Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO



Term 1

You have met Meriwether Lewis, who was President Jefferson's personal secretary and an officer in the United States Army. Now we will meet William Clark, a retired officer who had served alongside Lewis in the Army. He will be the expedition's co-leader. Here is a replica of the keelboat that was built for this expedition. It was 55 feet long (almost the length of a bowling alley) with room for about 20 men to row and more space for supplies.

∞ Image Link: Replica of keelboat

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Continue Ch.2 p.11-18 "Along the banks" - "of a dog."

- Why might a dog be a good companion for the expedition?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Statue of Lewis and Clark

This statue on the Ohio River in Clarksville, Indiana, marks the meeting place where the two explorers met.

WEEK 3 25m U.S. History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 3 *The Journey Begins*

 Materials: SeaMan: The Dog Who Explored The West With Lewis & Clark

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ INTRO

Today, you will read about the men who were chosen to be in the Corps (pronounced /kor/) of Discovery. What kind of skills do you think would be helpful for these men to have?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.18-27 "On November 20" - "a beautiful place."

→ VIEW

One of the goals of the expedition was to learn about plant and animal species and bring back samples. Here is a journal page that shows a drawing of a pheasant.

∞ Image Link: Journal Entry from Clark

• IMPORTANT DATES

1804 Lewis and Clark Expedition begins